

John Escobedo

Senior QA & UAT Lead | Accessibility (508/WCAG) & AI Output Validation | User-Centered, Trilingual Quality

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Austin, Texas

Summary: Senior QA and UAT lead with 18+ years making software work, and making it work for everyone. I build quality and user-acceptance programs from the ground up for healthcare, government, and e-commerce systems, bridge technical and business stakeholders, and stay calm and supportive with people under pressure. Trilingual (English, Spanish, ASL), with accessibility expertise shaped by years working alongside the Deaf community. I test not only whether software functions, but whether it genuinely serves the people who depend on it.

SKILLS

Testing

Manual & Exploratory, Functional, Regression, UAT, Integration, Smoke & Sanity, End-to-End, Usability

Test Management

Test Strategy & Planning, Test Case Design, Requirements Traceability, Defect Triage & Root Cause Analysis, Release Go/No-Go & Risk Assessment, HIPAA Compliance

API & Platforms

REST & SOAP API Testing (Postman), .NET & Java Systems, Web Applications, Mobile (iOS/Android), Desktop (Windows/Mac/Linux), Cross-Browser & Cross-Platform Compatibility

AI & LLM Validation

LLM Output Validation, Hallucination Detection & Fact-Checking, Red Teaming & Adversarial Testing, Prompt Engineering & Pipeline Design, AI Workflow Automation, AI Pair Programming (Claude Code), AI Assistants (Claude, ChatGPT, Gemini, Local Models)

Training & Enablement

Curriculum Development, Classroom & Workshop Facilitation, Software Instruction, Onboarding & Knowledge Transfer, SOP & Documentation Writing, One-on-One Coaching

Business Analysis

Requirements Elicitation, User Stories & Acceptance Criteria, Gap Analysis, Process Mapping, Functional Specifications, Stakeholder Management, Change Management

Customer Support

High-Touch & High-Volume Support, De-escalation & Conflict Resolution, Account Recovery, Live Chat & Ticket Systems (Parature), Active Listening & Empathetic Communication, Trust & Safety (Fraud & Exploit Investigation), Technical Troubleshooting & Incident Response

Accessibility & Inclusion

Section 508 & WCAG, JAWS & NVDA Screen Readers, Inclusive User Research, End-User Advocacy, Deaf Cultural Competency & ASL (Conversational)

Leadership & Collaboration

Team Leadership & Mentoring, Scrum Master & Agile Transformation, SDLC, Process Standardization, Cross-Functional Collaboration, Remote & Distributed Teams

Tools & Technologies

JIRA (Admin) & Confluence, Xray & TestRail, GitHub & CI/CD Workflows, Chrome DevTools, SQL & JQL, JavaScript/HTML/CSS, Command Line

Office & Creative Software

Office 365 (Teams, Word, Excel, PowerPoint, Outlook), Google Workspace (Drive, Docs, Sheets), Adobe Creative Suite (Photoshop, Illustrator, After Effects), Canva, GIMP

Live Events & A/V

Live Sound Engineering & Mixing, A/V Setup & Strike, Music Programming & Live Cueing, Performer & Client Coordination, Hosting & MC, Crowd Engagement

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Software Tester (Volunteer)

Sharpee.net | Austin, TX (Remote)

March 2026 to Present

Performed exploratory testing on a new web application, found silent-failure bugs that scripted tests missed, and contributed fixes and documentation directly to the codebase.

- Ran end-to-end exploratory testing across browsers and platforms, validating full user workflows.
 - Caught silent-failure bugs that scripted tests missed, including cases where the app returned blank responses with no error signal.
 - Built a custom failure-report template so any reader, technical or not, could immediately see what broke.
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Karaoke Host

Freelance | Austin, TX

July 2025 to Present

Hosted live karaoke events, running sound and software while managing the room and adapting the flow to the crowd.

- Ran event flow and timing, adjusting live to audience requests and room energy.
 - Juggled the song queue, timing, and room energy to keep the night moving.
 - Handled sound systems, karaoke software, and on-the-fly troubleshooting so events ran without interruption.
 - Kept the atmosphere welcoming so first-timers felt comfortable stepping up alongside regulars.
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Robot Tele-Operator

Appttronik (via Insight Global) | Austin, TX

July 2025 to September 2025

Tested and documented humanoid robot behavior for Appttronik, writing procedures and bug reports engineering could act on directly.

- Cut physical test setup time by 75% by standardizing the preparation pattern, giving data collection consistent, repeatable conditions.
 - Turned observed robot behaviors into clear bug reports engineering could act on immediately.
 - Wrote startup, shutdown, and emergency shutdown procedures for 2 robot models where none existed, cutting new-tester ramp-up time by roughly 50% and becoming the team standard.
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Senior QA Test Lead | Quality Assurance Tester | Scrum Master

GeekSI | Tallahassee, FL

March 2019 to June 2025

Led QA, UAT, and requirements analysis across multiple VA healthcare projects, drove Agile process adoption, and served as SME for complex clinical modules.

- Became the go-to SME for the Traumatic Brain Injury module, running knowledge transfer sessions so cross-functional teams could navigate the clinical requirements.
- Drove the Waterfall-to-Agile transition, introducing code freeze and release-candidate practices that shifted teams from reactive firefighting to predictable delivery.
- Managed test cases, defects, requirements documentation, and project dashboards in JIRA and Confluence across 6+ years and multiple VA projects.
- Ran SOAP API testing on VA home loan .NET applications and REST API testing via Postman on Java healthcare modules, validating service queries, data contracts, and data integrity.
- Built and executed test strategies for VA clinical healthcare applications across .NET and Java, covering UAT, regression, integration, smoke, sanity, end-to-end, and 508 compliance.
- Conducted user acceptance testing during two separate periods, organizing the testers, creating the tests, and gathering the results.

- Led 508 compliance initiatives and performed hands-on JAWS and NVDA screen-reader validation on VA clinical interfaces, catching accessibility issues visual inspection misses.
 - Partnered with automation engineers to validate Cucumber and Selenium scripts, catching requirement-to-execution gaps before tests went into rotation.
 - Built requirements traceability documentation mapping every business need to test coverage across web, mainframe, and mobile.
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DJ

Freelance | Austin, TX

January 2011 to April 2012

DJed dance events across Austin, working with venues and matching music to each event's tone and crowd.

- Built setlists for Danceversity, Dance International, and Synergy Dance Studio based on event style and audience preferences.
 - Adapted to different in-house sound systems and venue quirks on the fly.
 - Coordinated with event organizers to match music to the tone and timing of each event.
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Senior QA Test Lead | Quality Assurance Tester

EverlyWell | Austin, TX

June 2018 to October 2018

Established QA processes and JIRA workflows from the ground up for a health tech startup's secure patient portal, partnering with engineering and product leadership on release validation.

- As JIRA administrator, designed a unified workflow with custom issue types, permission schemes, notifications, and dashboards, giving engineering and product real-time visibility into release status.
 - Defined the initial QA process and release validation criteria for a team shipping without formal quality gates, bringing predictability to a fast-moving startup.
 - Assessed release risk and delivered go/no-go recommendations to product and engineering leadership, balancing speed to market with quality.
 - Validated releases across major browsers and mobile devices, catching requirement gaps before production.
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QA Test Lead | QA Analyst

YouScience | Austin, TX

July 2017 to June 2018

As sole QA, built quality processes and test infrastructure from zero for the flagship education assessment platform, earning trust with development and product teams.

- Introduced foundational quality practices, including version control discipline, release candidates, and structured validation, to a team shipping without formal QA process, integrating quality as a respected part of the SDLC.
 - Created end-to-end test and product documentation covering procedures, requirements traceability, verification standards, and feature release notes.
 - Standardized user story and acceptance criteria templates, reducing ambiguity between developers and QA and speeding up delivery.
 - Owned end-to-end validation for the flagship web application, gating every release across browsers and mobile platforms.
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QA Tester | QA Analyst

Luna Data Solutions | Austin, TX

May 2015 to May 2017

QA Analyst contracted to RetailMeNot, coordinating cross-team testing for high-visibility e-commerce launches and aligning test priorities with business needs.

- Coordinated QA across multiple teams for the gift card feature launch supporting a \$22M acquisition, aligning test priorities with leadership expectations.
 - Built custom JavaScript tools to validate site-wide analytics implementation and data integrity across the product.
 - Triaged live production issues under pressure, communicating status updates to leadership during outages.
 - Partnered with developers to improve internal tooling and CI/CD workflow, contributing changes that increased team efficiency.
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QA Test Lead | QA Analyst

Communication Services for the Deaf | Austin, TX

May 2013 to January 2015

Built the QA function for a video interpreting platform serving Deaf and hard-of-hearing users, immersing in the community to shape testing around real user needs.

- Learned American Sign Language and Deaf cultural norms to understand user needs firsthand, using that immersion as a user research approach that shaped requirements validation.
 - Established the company's first-ever QA function, defining test procedures and quality benchmarks that caught non-functional code blocking release.
 - Owned validation across web and mobile, from test planning through stakeholder reporting.
 - Expanded test coverage to previously unreachable environments by implementing a VirtualBox-based cross-platform solution.
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Lead QA Tester | Quality Assurance Tester

DocbookMD | Austin, TX

July 2012 to April 2013

Founded the QA function for a HIPAA-compliant healthcare messaging app, establishing regulatory-grade quality processes and validation strategy from zero.

- Analyzed and documented HIPAA compliance requirements, ensuring the app met regulatory standards for secure transmission of patient health information.
 - Built the initial test strategy and QA documentation from scratch, gating releases against both business and HIPAA compliance requirements.
 - Ran functional, regression, and HIPAA compliance validation across all supported mobile devices, creatively simulating wifi outages to catch edge cases scripted testing misses.
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QA Test Lead | QA Tester

Luna Data Solutions | Austin, TX

August 2011 to April 2012

Contracted as QA Tester at Heatwave Interactive and promoted to Test Lead, authoring test documentation and leading a team across multiple game titles.

- Authored test plans and documentation for smoke and regression cycles, improving coverage and consistency.
 - Led and mentored a team of testers, raising the bar on documentation quality and execution consistency.
 - Ran daily validation of game builds for core functionality, gameplay mechanics, and UI integrity.
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Event Coordinator and Host

Kick Butt Coffee | Austin, TX

January 2011 to April 2012

Organized and ran weekly dance events, handling vendors, tech setup, and community promotion.

- Ran weekly events, coordinating DJs, venue logistics, and crowd engagement.
- Set up audio and event tech to integrate with the venue's house sound system.

- Ran event promotion and community outreach through social media.
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Game Master | Customer Experience & Trust Specialist

Blizzard Entertainment | Austin, TX

July 2010 to July 2011

Delivered high-touch customer support for World of Warcraft, analyzing complex cases and documenting findings for development teams while maintaining user trust in a high-volume environment.

- Analyzed and documented fraud and exploitation cases, delivering detailed root cause reports to development teams.
 - De-escalated emotionally charged escalations through patient listening, restoring lost items and accounts and turning frustrated users into loyal ones.
 - Delivered high-volume support via live chat and ticket systems, balancing efficiency with genuine care.
 - Restored compromised accounts with precision, following strict security and data integrity protocols.
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QA Analyst | Support Tools Developer | Community Operations

Linden Lab | San Francisco, CA (Remote)

March 2007 to June 2010

Promoted three times from frontline support to QA Analyst, identifying operational gaps and building tools while establishing customer support processes.

- Built custom diagnostic tools to address operational gaps identified in support workflows.
 - Established customer support processes and documentation using the Parature ticket system and live chat.
 - As QA Analyst, tested daily builds and documented complex issues for engineering handoff.
 - Served as frontline First Responder, handling in-world emergencies, enforcing Terms of Service, and resolving user conflicts.
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QA Tester

Super Happy Fun Fun | Austin, TX

November 2006 to February 2007

Cross-platform compatibility testing for mobile games across 100+ device models, documenting platform-specific issues and building strategies for fragmented environments.

- Ran functional and compatibility testing across 100+ unique device models, building strategies for efficient testing across fragmented hardware and software platforms.
 - Tracked platform-specific bugs in Mantis with detailed analysis for developers.
 - Maintained quality oversight from initial builds through production patches.
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QA Test Lead, QA Game Tester

Aspyr Media | Austin, TX

February 2006 to November 2006

Handled QA for high-profile Mac game ports, authoring test documentation and partnering with development to isolate platform-specific issues.

- Authored test protocols and documentation to guide the testing team and establish organized standards.
- Validated major titles including Call of Duty 2 and Civilization IV through functional, compatibility, and regression testing, partnering with developers to isolate Mac-specific issues for stable launches.
- Documented, tracked, and verified defects in JIRA and DevTrack with clear, actionable reports.
- Caught localization and UI text errors through exhaustive proofreading, improving the polish of shipped titles.

Executive Assistant

LOC Consultants | Austin, TX
October 2005 to January 2006

Bilingual administrative support for an architectural firm, coordinating executive schedules and serving as primary communication point for a diverse client base.

- Delivered bilingual customer service in English and Spanish, handling high-volume communications and directing inquiries for a diverse client base.
- Managed the executive calendar, prioritizing scheduling conflicts.

Receptionist

GoDance Studios | Austin, TX
April 2005 to September 2005

Front desk point of contact for a dance studio, handling customer interactions and administrative operations.

- Handled customer check-ins and new student reservations, keeping the front desk running smoothly.
- Fielded inquiries from prospective students, explaining program details and booking reservations.
- Processed cash and card payments accurately.

Animator

Diva Productions | Austin, TX
November 2004 to April 2005

Owned the full animation production pipeline for educational children's content, running projects from script through final delivery.

- Ran end-to-end animation projects: writing scripts, building storyboards and animatics, and delivering final animations.
- Designed content to engage young audiences and reinforce learning objectives.
- Coordinated audio editing, syncing dialogue and sound to animated sequences.
- Maintained the studio's web presence and updates.

Building Monitor

UT Performing Arts Center | Austin, TX
October 2004 to November 2004

Provided security and access control for live performances at UT Performing Arts Center.

- Monitored venue access points, balancing performer access with security requirements.
- Maintained audience safety during performances.
- Ran building safety checks to identify and address issues before they escalated.

Designer

El Dia Daily Newspaper (Cuatro Communications) | Houston, TX
May 2004 to August 2004

Layout designer for a Spanish-language daily newspaper, working under daily deadline pressure to prepare content for publication.

- Designed and laid out newspaper pages in QuarkXPress and Adobe InDesign, supporting a platform migration between the two.
- Edited headlines and adjusted layouts under daily deadline pressure.
- Worked entirely in Spanish within a bilingual newsroom.

Digital Artist / Webmaster

Computer Discovery Center | Houston, TX
July 2002 to June 2004

Provided professional photo services and client consultation, turning customer requests into polished deliverables.

- Consulted with customers to understand requirements and turn requests into polished final products.
- Performed detailed photo editing and restoration in Adobe Photoshop.
- Supported artists with Giclée printing workflows, meeting print quality standards.

Minister / Web Master

Weddings Performed | Houston, TX
July 2002 to July 2003

Ordained wedding officiant performing bilingual ceremonies, gathering requirements from couples to craft personalized experiences.

- Consulted with couples to understand their vision and craft customized ceremonies.
- Officiated ceremonies for diverse couples, delivering personalized services in English and Spanish.
- Tutored the business owner on web design so they could maintain their own website.

Temp Worker

Adecco Temp Agency | Houston, TX
October 2002 to December 2003

Handled admin assignments across multiple client offices in document modernization and legal redlining.

- Assisted businesses with document modernization and updates.
- Learned document redlining processes for legal review.

Intern

Wild Brain | San Francisco, CA
January 2002 to April 2002

Interned at a professional animation studio, gaining production exposure while supporting operations.

- Supported studio operations through office assistance and workspace organization.
- Got hands-on experience with digital coloring workflows for animated productions.
- Developed traditional animation skills on professional equipment.

Teaching Assistant

Vista College | Berkeley, CA
October 2001 to May 2002

TA in a college design lab, tutoring students on Adobe applications and keeping workstations running for daily classes.

- Tutored students in Adobe Photoshop, Illustrator, and other applications.
- Troubleshoot lab workstations to keep them functional for class.

Graphic Designer

Management Strategies International | Berkeley, CA
November 2001 to February 2002

Created graphics and visual assets for client deliverables, collaborating with the team to meet content and client requirements.

- Designed graphics for client brochures and technical documentation.
 - Produced print-ready assets meeting project specifications.
 - Collaborated with the team to align designs with content and client requirements.
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Temporary Administrative Assistant

Adecco Northwest Division | Emeryville, CA

February 2001 to November 2001

Placed on multiple assignments across biotech (Chiron) and educational tech (Leap Frog).

- Assisted Chiron with decommissioning and archiving materials for a research project.
 - Supported Leap Frog product development, working with prototypes and creating educational quiz content.
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Contract Graphic Designer

DigitalThink.com | San Francisco

July 2000 to October 2000

Created visual assets for an eLearning platform, collaborating with course developers to communicate technical concepts visually.

- Designed instructional graphics to support technical eLearning course content.
 - Partnered with course developers to visually communicate complex concepts for online learners.
 - Optimized images for web delivery.
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Designer / Media Consultant

Mediaplex | San Francisco, CA

September 1999 to June 2000

Rich Media specialist researching emerging technologies and translating technical specifications into useful direction for engineering and product teams.

- Researched emerging web technologies and translated complex specifications into direction engineering and product could act on.
 - Partnered with engineering and product teams to expand platform capabilities based on research findings.
 - Evaluated browser ecosystems and compatibility requirements to shape cross-platform strategies.
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Contract Instructor

Media Alliance | San Francisco, CA

March 2001 to February 2002

Ran adult-ed workshops on Office, Photoshop, and web fundamentals for beginners entering the workforce.

- Designed and taught structured workshops on Microsoft Office Suite, Adobe Photoshop, and web fundamentals.
 - Provided one-on-one tutoring and technical assistance to keep students moving.
 - Managed the computer lab, keeping equipment and software ready for daily classes.
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Instructor

Tele Atlas (Formerly Etak) | Menlo Park, CA

November 2000 to January 2001

Developed and delivered training programs on data collection methodologies, evaluating trainee performance against quality standards.

- Developed and delivered training on data collection techniques, observational best practices, and proprietary software.

- Evaluated trainee performance through practical exercises and assessments to keep them aligned with quality guidelines.
 - Provided constructive feedback and one-on-one coaching to improve trainee accuracy and efficiency.
 - Served as go-to resource for protocol clarification, contributing to data quality improvement.
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Contract Instructor

Bay Area Video Coalition | San Francisco, CA

October 1999 to May 2000

Taught advanced Adobe After Effects and Dreamweaver at a professional video coalition, mentoring students on portfolio-quality work.

- Developed and taught curricula for Adobe After Effects and Dreamweaver.
 - Led multi-session workshops combining lecture, demonstration, and hands-on practice.
 - Mentored students on digital media production best practices, strengthening portfolio quality.
 - Provided constructive feedback on projects, fostering a collaborative learning environment.
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Instructor

Houston Multimedia Center | Houston, TX

January 1997 to April 1998

Designed and taught web design and motion graphics courses, guiding adult learners from concept through execution on real projects.

- Developed curriculum and taught classes on Adobe PageMill, HTML, Photoshop, and After Effects.
 - Broke down complex technical concepts into digestible lessons for varied learning styles.
 - Guided students through hands-on projects from concept to execution, building practical skills.
 - Provided individualized support and constructive feedback to help students master techniques.
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EDUCATION

Austin Community College - Austin, TX

American Sign Language

2015 – 2017

ASL School - Austin, TX

American Sign Language

2008 – 2012

Vista College - Berkeley, CA

Video Editing and Life Drawing

2001 – 2002

A.I. of Houston - Houston, TX

Fine Art, Typography, Layout, 3D Max

1995 – 1996

San Jacinto College - Pasadena, TX

Computer Science, Fine Art

1993 – 1995
